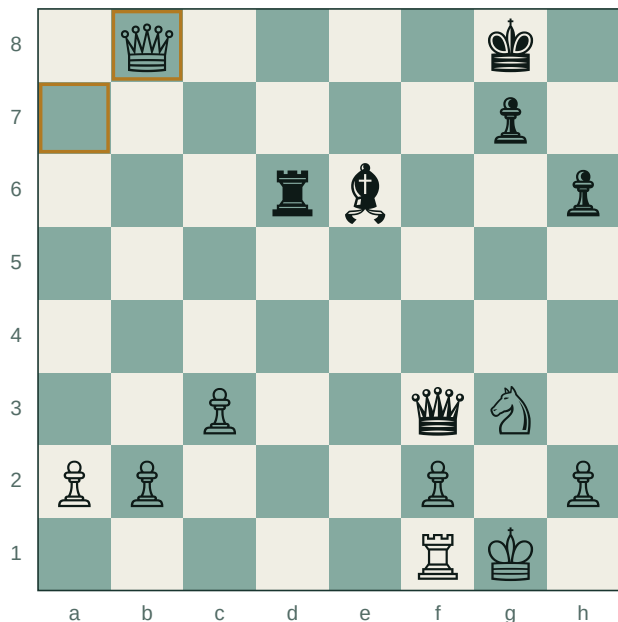


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 25

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Qb8+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Kh7 26. Qxd6 Bh3 27. Qd5 Qxd5

25...Kh7 The king moves from g8 to h7. Recorded reply: **26.Qxd6**.

26...Bh3 The bishop moves from e6 to h3. Recorded reply: **27.Qd5**.

27...Qxd5 The queen captures the queen on d5.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -3 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on b8. Check for tactical protection.